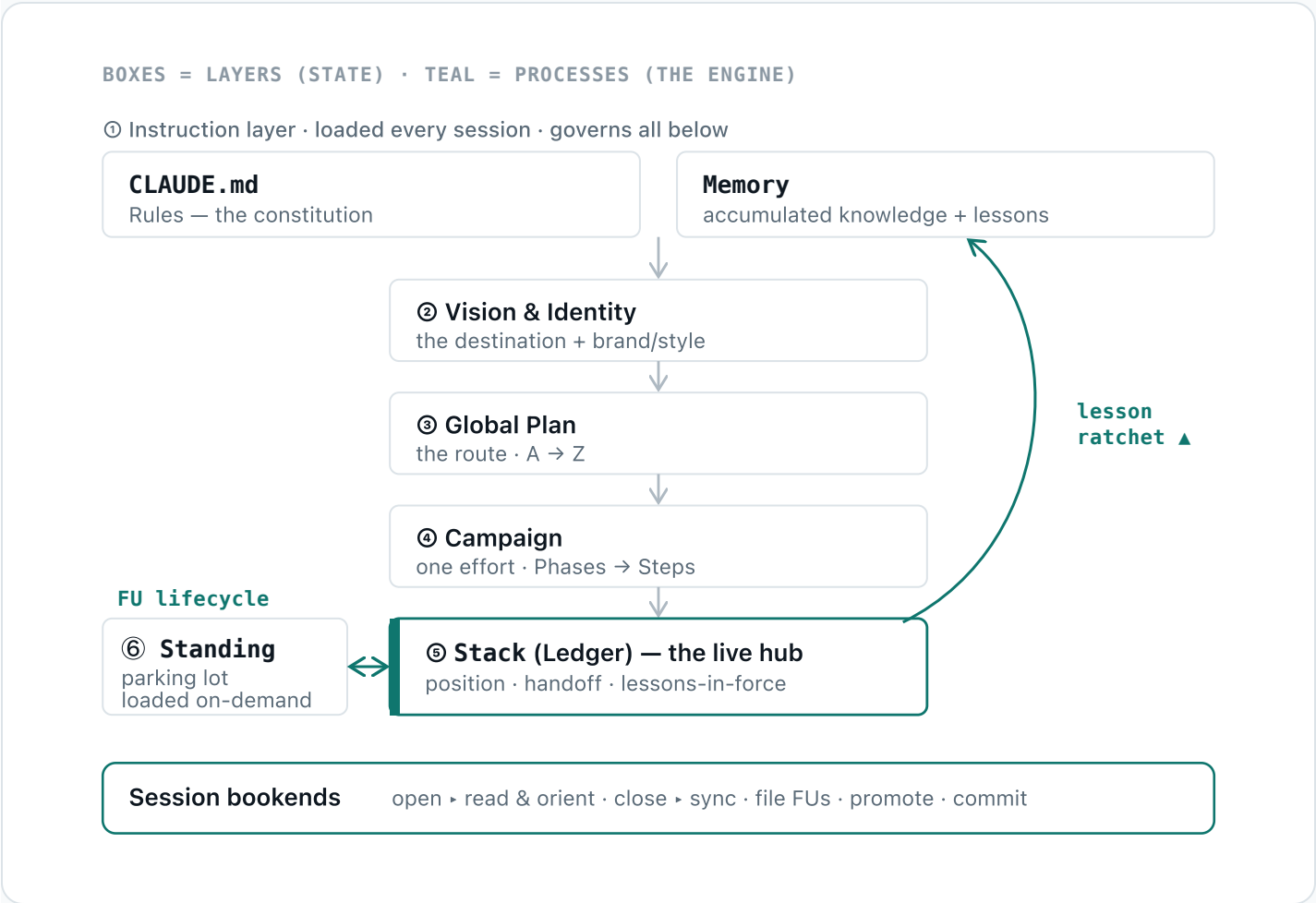


Keeping an agent's work coherent across sessions

Six layers hold the state; three processes move work between them. The whole system on one page — structured so nothing drifts and nothing is forgotten.



Stable at the top, volatile at the bottom. Everything teal is a verb — and all three converge on the ledger.

THE STRUCTURE

Six layers

Ordered top to bottom by stability — stable at the top (rarely changes), volatile at the bottom (rewritten every session). That ordering is *why* they're separate files: you never

want the churning part rewriting the stable part.

① **Instruction layer** CLAUDE.md · Memory

Two always-on stores. **CLAUDE.md (Rules)** is the constitution — how the agent works. **Memory** is accumulated knowledge: who you are, settled preferences, lessons that graduated. **Connects:** governs every layer below, and Memory is also where the lesson ratchet deposits.

③ **Global Plan** the route · A → Z

The sequenced route from today to the vision — the major efforts in order, and a "you are here." **Connects:** decomposes the vision into campaigns and links down to each one's plan.

⑤ **Stack (Ledger)** the live hub

The single always-current file for the active campaign: where you are, what's parked locally, lessons so far, and the handoff to the next session. Air traffic control — anti-drift, continuity, and lesson-accrual at once. **Connects:** reads up to the plan, parks and retrieves with the parking lot, and feeds Memory upward.

② **Vision & Identity** the destination

Where the project ultimately lands, plus the stable brand and style constraints beside it. **Connects:** rarely changes; it's the yardstick everything downstream is judged against.

④ **Campaign** Phases → Steps

One multi-phase effort — a module, feature, redesign, or refactor. Breaks into Phases then Steps and owns its own plan document. **Connects:** one is active at a time; its live position is tracked by the ledger, which only *points* at the breakdown, never copies it.

⑥ **Standing follow-ups** the parking lot

Cross-cutting tasks that can't finish inside any one campaign, or that wait on a **trigger** — an Nth occurrence, a date, an aggregated pass. **Connects:** loaded on-demand (not every session, to keep context lean); receives promoted items at phase close and is drawn down when a trigger fires.

THE ENGINE

Three processes

The layers are inert documents. These routines are what move work between them — and all three converge on the ledger.

A Session bookends

Open reads the ledger and restates position. Close writes the handoff, files new follow-ups, runs the lessons audit, and commits. These maintain every file above.

B Follow-up lifecycle

On discovery: route by kind (a bug by severity; a nice-to-have through a relevance filter), record as local (Stack) or standing (parking lot), batch like items, execute, and garbage-collect at phase close so nothing is orphaned.

C Lesson ratchet

A lesson earns a tally each time it proves useful. Clear the bar — recurs enough, generalizes, states in one line — and it graduates into permanent Memory, loaded forever after.

The one rule underneath all of it: **the process must stay lighter than the problem it solves** — scaled to the stakes, not minimized for its own sake. Heavier problems (money, security, data) earn more ceremony; trivial ones earn less. If tracking a thing costs more than the thing is worth, you don't track it.

Six layers · three processes · one constraint